

“With the ISA and other technologies being contributed to the open community, developers will have the tools to build innovative new hardware that takes advantage of POWER’s capabilities to process data-intensive workloads and create new



software applications for AI and hybrid clouds that are built to take advantage of the hardware’s unique capabilities,” the company said in a statement.

In addition, IBM plans to contribute a handful of other technologies to the open source community, including a softcore implementation of the IBM

POWER ISA, reference designs for the Open Coherent Accelerator Processor Interface (OpenCAPI) and the Open Memory Interface (OMI).

The OpenCAPI and OMI technologies help developers maximise memory bandwidth between processors and attached devices, which is critical to overcoming performance bottlenecks for emerging workloads like AI.

“With our recent Red Hat acquisition and this announcement, IBM becomes the only processor vendor and POWER becomes the only commercially-available architecture with a completely open system stack, from the foundation of the hardware through the software stack,” said IBM’s OpenPOWER general manager, Ken King.

The company also announced that it is moving the OpenPOWER Foundation under the Linux Foundation, where it will operate consistently with the Linux Foundation’s open governance principles. However, the OpenPOWER Foundation will retain its own board of directors.

IBM co-founded OpenPOWER in 2013, and since then the organisation has grown to over 350 members that have produced hundreds of innovations around the POWER architecture.

“The Linux Foundation itself has seen rising interest in open hardware communities and working with the OpenPOWER Foundation will continue to make the OpenPOWER and open hardware technologies available to a growing, global audience,” said Jim Zemlin, executive director of the Linux Foundation.

Binance is funding over 40 developers to build open source crypto software

Malta-based crypto exchange Binance wants to accelerate research in open source blockchain development. Towards that end, the exchange has unveiled Binance X,



a new initiative to help developers leverage Binance infrastructure for their ideas and projects.

As part of the initiative, Binance is funding more than 40 developers conducting research into open source crypto software. However, the exchange has not revealed how much funding these individuals will receive.

In addition to providing financial support, Binance X is also rolling out educational initiatives for developers and the public.

“The Binance X team will help educate, create opportunities for collaborations and jumpstart the growth of these projects via the different programmes and resources we have at Binance,” Teck Chia, head of Binance X, said in a statement.

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